

SAHIL SASTAKAR

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SUMMARY

- Master of Artificial Intelligence, Monash University (2024-2026, WAM 72.125). AI and graduate with hands-on experience building end-to-end machine learning pipelines, deploying AI systems, and delivering data-driven insights that produce measurable business outcomes.
- Delivered AI products achieving 84.5% image classification accuracy on 101k images, 85%+ LLM-based content generation accuracy (3x engagement uplift), and 40% reduction in client reporting effort through automated data pipelines adopted organisation-wide.
- Experienced across the full AI and data stack: Python, SQL, PyTorch, scikit-learn, LLM pipelines, REST APIs, Azure, Docker, Power BI, and Tableau. Proven communicator and leader with a track record of pitching ideas, building teams, and delivering from concept to production.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Centre for Technology Infusion, La Trobe University | Melbourne, VIC

Dec 2025 – Present

Research Assistant — AI and Data Science

- Designed and deployed an end-to-end ML pipeline on Azure processing 500+ live IoT sensor streams — covering data ingestion, feature engineering, model training, automated validation, and governed output delivery with zero data loss across all pipeline runs.
- Applied statistical ML techniques and SHAP-based explainability to noisy time-series sensor data, producing interpretable, reproducible model outputs that directly informed decision-making for research scientists and agricultural industry partners.
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to clarify requirements, translate complex model findings into clear business recommendations, and communicate results to non-technical audiences.
- Maintained comprehensive data governance documentation and pipeline records, enabling full team handover and ongoing auditability.

Foxberry Technologies | Pune, India

Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

Data Analyst Intern

- Built a Python and SQL classification model predicting property tax defaults across 3M+ residents, applying data cleaning, feature engineering, and model validation to a large and complex real-world government dataset.
- Designed and delivered Power BI and Tableau dashboards reducing manual reporting time by approximately 40%, presenting data-driven insights directly to senior government officials and influencing strategic policy decisions.
- Established repeatable data transformation workflows using Pandas and NumPy, adopted organisation-wide post-internship, demonstrating the ability to build scalable, maintainable data solutions.

PROJECTS AND VENTURES

RankMax.AI — Generative AI and Gamification Platform 2023 – 2024

Founder and CEO

Founded and built RankMax.AI independently, then led a team of 4 through Monash's DeepTech Entrepreneurship unit, pitching the venture at a Shark Tank-style showcase judged by a panel including representatives from Google, Antler, CDL Labs, and Monash Generator — one of 11 competing teams selected for the program.

- Conceived, designed, and built the core LLM pipeline independently: converted textbook content into structured quizzes at over 85% accuracy with XP and leaderboard gamification achieving an estimated 3x improvement in student engagement.
- Recruited and led a team of 4, drove product strategy and commercial positioning, and pitched the business model and technical vision to an expert panel of investors and industry leaders.

Intelli-harvest: AI-Driven Crop Optimisation | Monash DeepNeuron

2024

Project Lead

Attended a DeepNeuron showcase night, pitched the Intelli-harvest concept directly to the AI Executive Lead, and was recruited on the spot into a team lead role — one of the few students to enter MDN at manager level through a direct pitch rather than the standard selection process.

- Led a 5-person cross-functional team to design and deliver a full-stack crop optimisation tool integrating ground sensor data (N, P, K, pH), weather feeds, and microbial datasets using Generative AI, exceeding traditional accuracy benchmarks across all evaluation metrics.
- Drove the project from initial concept pitch through team formation, technical delivery, and final showcase, owning both the vision and the execution end to end.

OutbackShare — Food Relief Coordination Platform | Monash University FIT5120

2024 – 2025

AI/ML Lead

- Trained and deployed a ConvNeXt-Tiny image classifier on 101k images achieving 84.5% top-1 validation accuracy, selected over EfficientNet-B0 through rigorous controlled single-variable evaluation.
- Built a demand forecasting pipeline on ABS SEIFA 2021 and Census 2021 data using K-Means clustering (K=4, silhouette 0.275) and a River ARFRegressor for incremental online learning, with SHAP surrogate explanations and automated alerting for high-need postcodes.
- Designed the full PostgreSQL schema, migration SQL, seed scripts, and data governance documentation, enabling clean cross-functional team handover and long-term platform maintainability.

n8n AI Automation Pipeline | Self-hosted on Hostinger VPS 2025 – Present

Solo Builder

- Built a fully agentic n8n automation pipeline integrating Apify MCP, Gemini AI, Supabase, Google Drive, and Gmail API — reducing daily job search effort by 80% with zero manual input once deployed, demonstrating end-to-end AI systems thinking and production deployment capability.

EDUCATION

Monash University Clayton, VIC	2024 – 2026
<i>Master of Artificial Intelligence</i> WAM: 72.125	
Coursework: Reinforcement Learning, Deep Learning, Discrete Model Optimisation, Foundations of Data Science, Planning and Automated Reasoning.	
MIT-WPU Pune, India	2020 – 2023
<i>Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA)</i> CGPA: 9.3/10.0	

SKILLS

AI and Machine Learning: Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Deep Learning, Computer Vision, NLP, Online Learning (River), SHAP, Generative AI, LLM Pipelines, Prompt Engineering, Reinforcement Learning

Data and Analytics: SQL, PostgreSQL, Pandas, NumPy, Feature Engineering, Statistical Modelling, Power BI, Tableau, Data Governance, Data Pipelines

Cloud and Engineering: Azure, GCP, Docker, Git, CI/CD, FastAPI, REST APIs, Supabase, n8n, MCP Servers, VPS Deployment

Leadership and Communication: Team Leadership, Stakeholder Engagement, Pitching and Presenting, Cross-functional Collaboration, Technical Documentation, Agile Delivery